SSC CGL 2024 Tier-I question paper with answers

19 September 2024 · Shift 1

78 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 22 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/AnswerKeys/Writeup_Final_Anwerkey_CGLE_2024_T1_191224.pdf

Compare your score: the official 2024 cut-off (Tier-I, all posts except JSO and SI Grade-II), out of 200

UR 153.19 **OBC** 146.26 **EWS** 142.02 **SC** 126.46 **ST** 111.89 **ESM** 69.93 **OH** 113.10 **HH** 64.79 **VH** 102.97 **Other PwD** 45.74

Cut-offs apply to marks normalised across all the exam's shifts, so a raw score on one shift is a rough guide. Source: the official result write-up, https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/NoticeBoards/Result%20Write-up%20CGLE%202024%20Tier%20I_51224.pdf

General Intelligence and Reasoning 18 questions

Q.1

Which of the following terms will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? AWSO, KGCY, UQMI, EAWS, ?

(A) WAEI
(B) ZWTQ
(C) OKGC
(D) OGKH

Q.2

In a certain code language, ‘A + B’ means ‘A is the mother of B’; ‘A – B’ means ‘A is the brother of B’; ‘A × B’ means ‘A is the wife of B’ and ‘A ÷ B’ means ‘A is the father of B’. Based on the above, how is A related to D if ‘A × B ÷ C × D’?

(A) Father’s sister
(B) Father’s brother
(C) Wife's mother
(D) Father-in-law

Q.7

Which number will come in the place of the question mark (?) in the following equation if ‘+’ and ‘–’ are interchanged and ‘×’ and ‘÷’ are interchanged? 20 + 10 × 2 – 4 ÷ 5 = ?

(A) 30
(B) 35
(C) 40
(D) 45

Q.8

In a certain code language, ‘TOUGH’ is coded as ‘89251’ and ‘GHOST’ is coded as ‘93258’. What is the code for ‘S’ in the given code language?

(A) 3
(B) 1
(C) 9
(D) 8

Q.9

‘Wander’ is related to ‘Ramble’ in the same way as ‘Stray’ is related to ‘_____’. (The words must be considered as meaningful English words and must not be related to each other based on the number of letters/number of consonants/vowels in the word.)

(A) Constant
(B) Random
(C) Trek
(D) Steady

Q.10

Each of the letters in the word 'KEYBOARD' are arranged in the English alphabetical order. How many letters are in the English alphabetical order between the letter which is the third from the right end and the second from the right end in the group of letters thus formed?

(A) Four
(B) Three
(C) One
(D) Two

Q.11

'RUCK' is related to 'TWAI' in a certain way based on the English alphabetical order. In the same way, 'DPHM' is related to 'FRFK'. To which of the following is 'KNOM' related, following the same logic?

(A) IPMJ
(B) MPMK
(C) IQNK
(D) MQNJ

Q.12

Two sets of numbers are given below. In each set of numbers, certain mathematical operation(s) on the first number result(s) in the second number. Similarly, certain mathematical operation(s) on the second number result(s) in the third number and so on. Which of the given options follows the same set of operations as in the given sets? (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into their constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/subtracting/multiplying to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.) 11 – 14 – 8 – 17; 12 – 15 – 9 – 18

(A) 5 – 8 – 3 – 10
(B) 6 – 9 – 3 – 12
(C) 3 – 6 – 2 – 8
(D) 4 – 7 – 12 – 18

Q.13

Select the option that represents the letters that when placed from left to right in the blanks below will complete the given letter series. B _ E N B _ C E N B B C _ N B B C E _ B _ C

(A) CNEBB
(B) BNECB
(C) CBENB
(D) BCENB

Q.16

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. 14 : 30 :: 9 : 20 :: 4 : ? (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc., to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 11
(B) 10
(C) 13
(D) 12

Q.17

In a certain code language, 'SHE' is written as 'EIT' and 'SAD' is written as 'DBT'. How will 'SUN' be written in that language?

(A) NYT
(B) NTY
(C) NTV
(D) NVT

Q.18

Based on the English alphabetical order, three of the following four letter-clusters are alike in a certain way and thus form a group. Which is the letter-cluster that DOES NOT belong to that group? (Note: The odd man out is not based on the number of consonants/vowels or their position in the letter-cluster.)

(A) CHE
(B) FLI
(C) MSP
(D) AGD

Q.19

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusion(s) logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: Some eagles are sparrows. All sparrows are parrots. No parrot is a penguin. Conclusions: (I) Some parrots are eagles. (II) No penguin is a sparrow.

(A) Only conclusion I follows.
(B) Only conclusion II follows.
(C) Both conclusions I and II follow.
(D) Neither conclusion I nor II follows.

Q.20

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 3, 17, 83, 329, ?, 1961

(A) 983
(B) 880
(C) 980
(D) 883

Q.21

17 is related to 21 following a certain logic. Following the same logic, 22 is related to 36. To which of the following is 29 related, following the same logic? (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc., to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 57
(B) 46
(C) 49
(D) 58

Q.22

BIRTHDAY - IBTRDHYA BLAZER - LBZARE REMOVE - ? Using the same logic as applied for the first two pairs of terms, select the term that can replace the question mark (?) in the third pair.

(A) EROMEV
(B) ERMOVE
(C) EROMVE
(D) EVOMER

Q.23

The same operation(s) are followed in all the given number pairs except one. Find that odd number pair. (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc., to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 24 : 4
(B) 49 : 8
(C) 19 : 3
(D) 55 : 9

Q.24

What will come in place of the question mark (?) in the following equation, if '+' and '–' are interchanged and '×' and '÷' are interchanged? $1205 \times 5 + 35 - 197 \div 18 = ?$

(A) 3284
(B) 3482
(C) 3752
(D) 3824

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

In which of the following years was the Right of Persons with Disabilities Act passed?

(A) 2010
(B) 2002
(C) 2016
(D) 2019

Q.2
Who among the following was one of the recipients of the inaugural 'Prof CR Rao Centenary Gold Medal' award in 2021?

(A) Amartya Sen
(B) Jagdish Bhagwati
(C) Raghuram Rajan
(D) Surjit Bhalla

Q.3
Which of the following Articles states that the Prime Minister should be appointed by the President?

(A) Article 75
(B) Article 66
(C) Article 62
(D) Article 71

Q.4
Due to which of the following events did Rabindranath Tagore return the title of 'Knighthood' to the British Government while expressing his anguish?

(A) Charan Paduka Incident
(B) Chauri Chaura Incident
(C) Jallianwala Bagh massacre
(D) Partition of Bengal

Q.5
In which sport did India win its first individual Olympic medal?

(A) Judo
(B) Wrestling
(C) Swimming
(D) Shooting

Q.6
Which of the following is an example of Phylum Arthropoda?

(A) Pila
(B) Butterfly
(C) Nereis
(D) Hirudinaria

Q.7
Tarun Bhattacharya, who was awarded the Sangeet Natak Akademi Award in 2018, is known for playing which musical instrument?

(A) Sitar
(B) Santoor
(C) Violin
(D) Tabla

Q.8
Which of the following is a component of the SHG-bank linkage program in India?

(A) Microfinance institutions providing loans directly to SHGs
(B) State government providing subsidies to SHGs for credit
(C) Non-governmental organisations providing capacity building training to SHGs
(D) Banks providing loans to individual members of SHGs

Q.9
As per the Timurid tradition, Humayun had to share power with his brothers. Humayun had the control of Delhi, Agra and Central India, while his brother Kamran controlled which of the following regions?

(A) Deccan
(B) Afghanistan and Punjab
(C) Gujarat and Rajasthan
(D) Bengal and Bihar

Q.10
Navratri festival is dedicated to which of the following Goddesses?

(A) Laxmi
(B) Jawala
(C) Saraswati
(D) Durga

Q.11
Which two organic chemists are known for observing the peroxide effect in adding reagents to unsaturated compounds in 1933?

(A) Justus von Liebig and Friedrich Wöhler
(B) Morris S Kharasch and Frank R Mayo
(C) B Steven Bachrach and Roald Hoffmann
(D) C John Cadogan and Luis M Campos

Q.12
The oath of office to the Vice-President is administered by the _____.

(A) Chief Justice of India
(B) Prime Minister
(C) CAG
(D) President

Q.13
What was the name of the wind measuring instrument invented for the first time in 1450?

(A) Anemometer
(B) Ceiling Projector
(C) Transmissometer
(D) Dropsonde

Q.14
As per a report of the Ministry of Labour and Employment, what was the rate of unemployment in Maharashtra for the year 2021-22?

(A) 3.5%
(B) 3.01%
(C) 4.4%
(D) 4.2%

Q.15
Which of the following is NOT a unit of energy?

(A) Joule
(B) Kilowatt hour
(C) Calorie
(D) Newton

Q.16
The Wardha is a tributary of which of the following rivers?

(A) Mahanadi river
(B) Narmada river
(C) Godavari river
(D) Tapi river

Q.17
Pandit Omkar Nath Thakur was a student of _____.

(A) Pandit Vishnu Narayan Bhatkhande
(B) Pandit Vishnu Digambar Paluskar
(C) Pandit Gopal Shankar Mishra
(D) Ustad Abdul Karim Khan

Q.18
Vijender Singh has represented India in Olympics for how many times?

(A) 3
(B) 4
(C) 5
(D) 2

Q.19
Who among the following classical dancers is NOT related to Odissi?

(A) Mayadhar Raut
(B) Kiran Segal
(C) Kumkum Mohanty
(D) Geetanjali Lal

Q.20
What were the main obstacles during the industrial development of India at the time of independence?

(A) Employment required for industries
(B) Capital investment in industries
(C) Market for industrial produce
(D) Land for industrial establishment

Q.21

Khudai Khidmatgar, a voluntary organisation, was established by which of the following leaders of India?

(A) Muhammad Ali Jinnah
(B) Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan
(C) Maulana Muhammad Ali
(D) Hakim Ajmal Khan

Q.22

Which of the following is NOT a Fundamental Duty?

(A) To prohibit trade in rare and endangered species
(B) To safeguard public property and to abjure violence
(C) To uphold and protect the sovereignty, unity and integrity of India
(D) To value and preserve rich heritage of the country's composite culture

Q.23

What is the other name of tetanus caused by toxin producing bacteria called clostridium tetani?

(A) Broken jaw
(B) Snap jaw
(C) Cleft jaw
(D) Lockjaw

Q.24

During which of the following rules did Buddhism get split into two schools - Hinayana and Mahayana in the fourth Buddhist council?

(A) Gupta
(B) Parthian
(C) Kushana
(D) Shaka

Q.25

As of Financial year 2019, which of the following state has the highest road density in India?

(A) Haryana
(B) Tamil Nadu
(C) Punjab
(D) Kerala

Quantitative Aptitude 10 questions

Q.1

A vendor started selling vegetables at ₹10 per kg, but couldn't find buyers at this rate. So he reduced the price to ₹7.2 per kg, but uses a faulty weight of 900 g instead of 1 kg. Find the percentage change in the actual price.

(A) 10%
(B) 15%
(C) 25%
(D) 20%

Q.2

15 kg of ₹10 per kg wheat is mixed with 5 kg of another type of wheat to get a mixture costing ₹30 per kg. Find the price (per kg) of the costlier wheat.

(A) ₹90
(B) ₹70
(C) ₹60
(D) ₹80

Q.5

AB is a chord of length 32 cm of a circle of radius 20 cm, the tangents at A and B intersect at a point T. Find length TA (rounded off to two digits after decimal).

(A) 21.33 cm
(B) 36.50 cm
(C) 26.67 cm
(D) 19.93 cm

Q.6

P, Q and R are the three angles of a triangle. If P – Q = 20° and Q – R = 26°, then ∠P is equal to:

(A) 82°
(B) 46°
(C) 52°
(D) 92°

Q.7

Each of Ravi and Kavita had some marbles. Kavita had 12 more marbles than Ravi had. If each of them had one more marble, then three times the number of marbles Kavita would then have had would have been equal to four times the number of marbles Ravi would then have had. How many marbles did Kavita actually have?

(A) 51
(B) 48
(C) 43
(D) 47

Q.10

WXYZ is a quadrilateral in which XQ and ZP are perpendicular to WY such that XQ = ZP. Diagonals ZX and WY intersect each other at point O. If OX = 12 cm, then find the value of ZX (in cm).

(A) 18
(B) 24
(C) 36
(D) 12

Q.11

The cost of a diamond varies directly as the square of its weight. Once, this diamond broke into four pieces with weights in the ratio of 4 : 3 : 2 : 1 .When the pieces were sold, the merchant got ₹63,000 less than that of one piece. Find the original price of the diamond.

(A) ₹80,000
(B) ₹90,000
(C) ₹86,000
(D) ₹75,000

Q.17

The cost of tomatoes per kg is increased by 300%. A housewife reduces her consumption of tomatoes by 70%. By what percentage does her expenditure on tomatoes increase or decrease?

(A) Decreases, 30%
(B) Increases, 20%
(C) Decreases, 20%
(D) Increases, 30%

Q.19

Aman invested a sum of money in scheme A at the rate of 8% p.a. for a period of 5 years on simple interest. He invested four times of the sum of scheme A in scheme B at the rate of 5% p.a. for 7 years on simple interest. He received a total interest amount of ₹1,620. How much (in ₹) did he invest in scheme B?

(A) 900
(B) 3,200
(C) 2,400
(D) 3,600

Q.21

Two trains of lengths 150 m and 250 m run on parallel lines. When they run in the same direction, they take 20 seconds to cross each other and, when they run in the opposite direction, they take 5 seconds to cross each other. What is the speed of the two trains?

(A) 150 km/h and 105 km/h
(B) 180 km/h and 108 km/h
(C) 150 km/h and 250 km/h
(D) 160 km/h and 106 km/h

English Comprehension 25 questions

Q.1

Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph. A. However, their population is declining nowadays due to noise pollution. B. It is one of the most common birds along with the other two species, the European starling, and the rock pigeon. C. Their constant presence outside our homes makes it easy to overlook them. D. House sparrows can be found in most places with and without houses (or other structures).

(A) DABC
(B) DBCA
(C) DACB
(D) BDCA

Q.2

Out of the four sentences given, three have spelling errors. Identify the sentence that has no spelling error.

(A) She tried to manoeuvre her trolley around people.
(B) The computer's software detected an anamoly caused by a virus.
(C) What advice did he give to young entreprenuers?
(D) A clergyman read the litturgy from the prayer-book.

Q.3

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Start from scratch

(A) To start or create something from the very beginning
(B) To point out something wrong
(C) To address an issue
(D) To develop something out of waste material

Q.4

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. The police told the agitators to back in, else they would lathi-charge.

(A) The police told
(B) the agitators to back in
(C) lathi-charge
(D) else they would

Q.5

Select the most appropriate order of the segments in the options that will fill in the blanks and make a coherent paragraph. Though Sheela loves watching horror movies,
_____/_____/_____/_____ she rented another romantic today.

(A) she planned to try something different yesterday / so she rented the latest romantic / and to her surprise she enjoyed it very much / so much so that
(B) so much so that / and to her surprise she enjoyed it very much / she planned to try something different yesterday / so she rented the latest romantic
(C) so she rented the latest romantic / and to her surprise she enjoyed it very much / so much so that / she planned to try something different yesterday
(D) and to her surprise she enjoyed it very much /so much so that /so she rented the latest romantic /she planned to try something different yesterday

Q.6

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Transnational linkages, for example, sever the nation-state’s “integrity and corrupt” state-society relations.

(A) cohesion and erode
(B) divergence and relativity
(C) severance and revolution
(D) controversy and diminution

Q.7

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice. The cashier had finished the assigned task on time.

(A) The assigned task was finished by the cashier on time.
(B) The assigned task has been finished by the cashier on time.
(C) The assigned task had been finished by the cashier on time.
(D) The assigned task is finished by the cashier on time.

Q.8

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Garnish

(A) Dwindle
(B) Decorate
(C) Blemish
(D) Tarnish

Q.9

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Determined

(A) hesitant
(B) loathe
(C) resolute
(D) faltering

Q.10

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. His house “is smaller than you” .

(A) is smaller than your
(B) is smaller than yours
(C) is small as you
(D) is small than you

Q.11

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word to fill in the blank. Capricious Share market prices have remained _____ for weeks.

(A) fickle
(B) stable
(C) volatile
(D) mischievous

Q.12

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice. Data is being collected by the researcher.

(A) The researcher is collecting data.
(B) The researcher has been collecting data.
(C) The researcher has collected data.
(D) The researcher will be collecting data.

Q.13

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word. Evenings get “dark” very early in this cold weather.

(A) Bright
(B) Dim
(C) Shadowy
(D) Gloomy

Q.14

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A person who performs magic to entertain people

(A) Angel
(B) Magician
(C) Palmist
(D) Alchemist

Q.15

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word in the given sentence. Fundamentels of every subject need to be learnt on priority basis.

(A) basis
(B) learnt
(C) priority
(D) Fundamentels

Q.16

Select the most appropriate option that has the same meaning as the italicised segment. His illness became “a blessing in disguise” when he married his nurse.

(A) an apparent misfortune that eventually has good results

(B) when someone finds it difficult to choose between two alternatives

(C) deal with a problem if and when it becomes necessary

(D) to present a counter-argument

Q.17

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Desolate

(A) Frugal

(B) Allusive

(C) Festive

(D) Melancholic

Q.18

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. We took dinner in a Chinese restaurant and were amazed to see the interior of a restaurant.

(A) in a Chinese restaurant

(B) and were amazed to see

(C) the interior of a restaurant

(D) We took dinner

Q.19

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given phrase. A person who is kept captive for fulfilment of demands of money or conditions

(A) Hostage

(B) Hermit

(C) Heretic

(D) Introvert

Q.20

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Fallacy

(A) Veracity

(B) Error

(C) Evidence

(D) Verify

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. When Ojeya Cruz Banks moved to Ohio from New Zealand (1) _____ years ago, she was overwhelmed by the logistics of uprooting her life. But Cruz Banks, a Denison University professor and a single mom, who is also my neighbour and friend, was (2) _____ to find a house next to a public elementary school. She assumed that she would be able to walk to pick up her daughter, a needed convenience given that she didn’t yet have a car. Unfortunately, when she went to register her daughter for kindergarten, she was met with an (3) _____ surprise: The only (4) _____ option was a half-day program that would bus students to a day-care centre on the outskirts of the town for the afternoon. The district did offer a limited number of full-day slots, but those had all been claimed in a lottery earlier that spring and came with a tuition cost. “I was like, ‘Cost me? What? Public school costs money here?’” she told me. Many parents across the United States, like Cruz Banks, may assume that free, full-day kindergarten is a (5) _____ part of the country’s public education system. I was one of them, until my youngest had to enter our district’s lottery several months ago. When he was assigned to the half-day program, I swung between alarm and frustration.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 1.

(A) particular

(B) several

(C) immense

(D) enormous

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. When Ojeya Cruz Banks moved to Ohio from New Zealand (1) _____ years ago, she was overwhelmed by the logistics of uprooting her life. But Cruz Banks, a Denison University professor and a single mom, who is also my neighbour and friend, was (2) _____ to find a house next to a public elementary school. She assumed that she would be able to walk to pick up her daughter, a needed convenience given that she didn't yet have a car. Unfortunately, when she went to register her daughter for kindergarten, she was met with an (3) _____ surprise: The only (4) _____ option was a half-day program that would bus students to a day-care centre on the outskirts of the town for the afternoon. The district did offer a limited number of full-day slots, but those had all been claimed in a lottery earlier that spring and came with a tuition cost. "I was like, 'Cost me? What? Public school costs money here?'" she told me. Many parents across the United States, like Cruz Banks, may assume that free, full-day kindergarten is a (5) _____ part of the country's public education system. I was one of them, until my youngest had to enter our district's lottery several months ago. When he was assigned to the half-day program, I swung between alarm and frustration.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 2.

(A) distraught
(B) dispassionate
(C) worried
(D) relieved

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. When Ojeya Cruz Banks moved to Ohio from New Zealand (1) _____ years ago, she was overwhelmed by the logistics of uprooting her life. But Cruz Banks, a Denison University professor and a single mom, who is also my neighbour and friend, was (2) _____ to find a house next to a public elementary school. She assumed that she would be able to walk to pick up her daughter, a needed convenience given that she didn't yet have a car. Unfortunately, when she went to register her daughter for kindergarten, she was met with an (3) _____ surprise: The only (4) _____ option was a half-day program that would bus students to a day-care centre on the outskirts of the town for the afternoon. The district did offer a limited number of full-day slots, but those had all been claimed in a lottery earlier that spring and came with a tuition cost. "I was like, 'Cost me? What? Public school costs money here?'" she told me. Many parents across the United States, like Cruz Banks, may assume that free, full-day kindergarten is a (5) _____ part of the country's public education system. I was one of them, until my youngest had to enter our district's lottery several months ago. When he was assigned to the half-day program, I swung between alarm and frustration.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 3.

(A) unpleasant
(B) agreeable
(C) amusing
(D) enjoyable

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. When Ojeya Cruz Banks moved to Ohio from New Zealand (1) _____ years ago, she was overwhelmed by the logistics of uprooting her life. But Cruz Banks, a Denison University professor and a single mom, who is also my neighbour and friend, was (2) _____ to find a house next to a public elementary school. She assumed that she would be able to walk to pick up her daughter, a needed convenience given that she didn't yet have a car. Unfortunately, when she went to register her daughter for kindergarten, she was met with an (3) _____ surprise: The only (4) _____ option was a half-day program that would bus students to a day-care centre on the outskirts of the town for the afternoon. The district did offer a limited number of full-day slots, but those had all been claimed in a lottery earlier that spring and came with a tuition cost. "I was like, 'Cost me? What? Public school costs money here?'" she told me. Many parents across the United States, like Cruz Banks, may assume that free, full-day kindergarten is a (5) _____ part of the country's public education system. I was one of them, until my youngest had to enter our district's lottery several months ago. When he was assigned to the half-day program, I swung between alarm and frustration.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 4.

(A) inaccessible
(B) available
(C) futile
(D) nonviable

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. When Ojeya Cruz Banks moved to Ohio from New Zealand (1) _____ years ago, she was overwhelmed by the logistics of uprooting her life. But Cruz Banks, a Denison University professor and a single mom, who is also my neighbour and friend, was (2) _____ to find a house next to a public elementary school. She assumed that she would be able to walk to pick up her daughter, a needed convenience given that she didn't yet have a car. Unfortunately, when she went to register her daughter for kindergarten, she was met with an (3) _____ surprise: The only (4) _____ option was a half-day program that would bus students to a day-care centre on the outskirts of the town for the afternoon. The district did offer a limited number of full-day slots, but those had all been claimed in a lottery earlier that spring and came with a tuition cost. "I was like, 'Cost me? What? Public school costs money here?'" she told me. Many parents across the United States, like Cruz Banks, may assume that free, full-day kindergarten is a (5) _____ part of the country's public education system. I was one of them, until my youngest had to enter our district's lottery several months ago. When he was assigned to the half-day program, I swung between alarm and frustration.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 5.

(A) inessential
(B) disapproved
(C) ceaseless
(D) required

Answer key

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(D)**
Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(B)**	Q.13 **(C)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(A)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(C)**

General Awareness

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(A)**
Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(C)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(A)**	Q.7 **(D)**	Q.10 **(B)**
Q.11 **(B)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.19 **(D)**	Q.21 **(B)**		

English Comprehension

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

Explanations

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (C) OKGC

Each letter moves 10 places forward, wrapping round after Z: A, K, U, E, O; W, G, Q, A, K; S, C, M, W, G; O, Y, I, S, C. The next term is OKGC.

Q.2 · Answer (C) Wife's mother

A is the wife of B, B is the father of C and C is the wife of D. So A is C's mother, and C is D's wife: A is D's wife's mother.

Q.7 · Answer (B) 35

After interchanging the signs: 20 – 10 ÷ 2 + 4 × 5 = 20 – 5 + 20 = 35.

Q.8 · Answer (A) 3

T, O, G and H are in both words, as are 8, 9, 2 and 5 in both codes. The letter left in GHOST is S and the digit left in its code is 3, so S = 3.

Q.9 · Answer (B) Random

'Wander' and 'ramble' are synonyms: to move about aimlessly. Of the options only 'random' means the same as 'stray' (a stray remark is a random one).

Q.10 · Answer (D) Two

KEYBOARD in alphabetical order is A B D E K O R Y. The third from the right is O and the second from the right is R; between them come P and Q: two letters.

Q.11 · Answer (B) MPMK

The first two letters move 2 places forward and the last two move 2 places back: RUCK → TWAI and DPHM → FRFK. So KNOM → MPMK.

Q.12 · Answer (B) 6 – 9 – 3 – 12

Each set adds 3, subtracts 6, then adds 9: 11, 14, 8, 17 and 12, 15, 9, 18. Likewise 6, 9, 3, 12.

Q.13 · Answer (C) CBENB

With C, B, E, N, B in the blanks the block BCENB repeats: BCENB BCENB BCENB BCENB BC.

Q.16 · Answer (B) 10

The second number is twice the first plus 2: 14 × 2 + 2 = 30 and 9 × 2 + 2 = 20. Likewise 4 × 2 + 2 = 10.

Q.17 · Answer (D) NVT

The word is written backwards and its last two letters then move one place forward: SHE → E H S → EIT and SAD → D A S → DBT. So SUN → N U S → NVT.

Q.18 · Answer (A) CHE

In FLI, MSP and AGD the letters move +6, then –3. CHE moves +5, then –3, so it is the odd one.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Both conclusions I and II follow.

Some eagles are sparrows and all sparrows are parrots, so some parrots are eagles (I). All sparrows are parrots and no parrot is a penguin, so no penguin is a sparrow (II). Both follow.

Q.20 · Answer (A) 983

Each term is the one before times 6, 5, 4, 3, 2, minus 1, 2, 3, 4, 5: 3 × 6 – 1 = 17, 17 × 5 – 2 = 83, 83 × 4 – 3 = 329, 329 × 3 – 4 = 983 and 983 × 2 – 5 = 1961.

Q.21 · Answer (A) 57

The second number is three times the first minus 10: (17 – 10) × 3 = 21 and (22 – 10) × 3 = 36. So (29 – 10) × 3 = 57.

Q.22 · Answer (A) EROMEV
Each pair of letters is swapped: BI RT HD AY → IB TR DH YA and BL AZ ER → LB ZA RE. So RE MO VE → ER OM EV: EROMEV.

Q.23 · Answer (A) 24 : 4
In 49 : 8, 19 : 3 and 55 : 9 the second number is the first minus 1, divided by 6: 48 ÷ 6 = 8, 18 ÷ 6 = 3 and 54 ÷ 6 = 9. For 24 : 4, 23 ÷ 6 is not 4, so it is the odd pair.

Q.24 · Answer (C) 3752
After interchanging the signs: 1205 ÷ 5 − 35 + 197 × 18 = 241 − 35 + 3546 = 3752.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (C) 2016
The Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act was passed in December 2016, replacing the Persons with Disabilities Act of 1995.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Jagdish Bhagwati
Jagdish Bhagwati and C Rangarajan were the first recipients of the medal, instituted by The Indian Econometric Society's trust to mark C R Rao's centenary.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Article 75
Under Article 75(1) the Prime Minister is appointed by the President, and the other ministers by the President on the Prime Minister's advice.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Jallianwala Bagh massacre
Tagore gave up his knighthood in May 1919 in protest at the Jallianwala Bagh massacre in Amritsar that April.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Wrestling
K D Jadhav's bronze in wrestling at the 1952 Helsinki Olympics was independent India's first individual Olympic medal.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Butterfly
Butterflies are insects, and insects are arthropods. Pila (the apple snail) is a mollusc; Nereis and Hirudinaria (the leech) are annelids.

Q.7 · Answer (B) Santoor
Pandit Tarun Bhattacharya is a santoor player.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Banks providing loans to individual members of SHGs
SSC's key gives bank loans to SHG members. Under NABARD's SHG-bank linkage programme, begun in 1992, banks lend to the groups, which pass the credit on to their individual members; NGOs that form and train the groups also take part, so the question is loosely worded.

Q.9 · Answer (B) Afghanistan and Punjab
Kamran held Kabul and Kandahar, in present-day Afghanistan, and also took the Punjab.

Q.10 · Answer (D) Durga
Navratri's nine nights are dedicated to Goddess Durga in her nine forms.

Q.11 · Answer (B) Morris S Kharasch and Frank R Mayo
In 1933 Morris Kharasch and Frank Mayo showed that peroxides reverse the way HBr adds to an alkene (anti-Markovnikov addition): the peroxide effect.

Q.12 · Answer (D) President
Under Article 69 the Vice-President takes the oath before the President, or a person the President appoints for the purpose.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Anemometer
The Italian architect Leon Battista Alberti described the first mechanical anemometer, a swinging-plate design, around 1450.

Q.14 · Answer (A) 3.5%
The Periodic Labour Force Survey 2021-22 put Maharashtra's unemployment rate (usual status, persons aged 15 and above) at 3.5%, below the all-India 4.1%.

Q.15 · Answer (D) Newton
The newton is the unit of force. Joules, kilowatt hours and calories all measure energy.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Godavari river
The Wardha joins the Wainganga to form the Pranhita, which flows into the Godavari.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Pandit Vishnu Digambar Paluskar
Omkarnath Thakur trained under Vishnu Digambar Paluskar at the Gandharva Mahavidyalaya.

Q.18 · Answer (A) 3
Vijender Singh boxed at the 2004, 2008 and 2012 Olympics, winning bronze at Beijing in 2008.

Q.19 · Answer (D) Geetanjali Lal
Geetanjali Lal is a Kathak dancer. Mayadhar Raut, Kiran Segal and Kumkum Mohanty are Odissi dancers.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Capital investment in industries
SSC's key gives capital. In NCERT's account, Indian industrialists at independence did not have the capital for the large investments industry needed; it adds that the market was not big enough either, so that option is also arguable.

Q.21 · Answer (B) Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan
Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan, the 'Frontier Gandhi', founded the Khudai Khidmatgar (Servants of God) in 1929.

Q.22 · Answer (A) To prohibit trade in rare and endangered species
Article 51A lists safeguarding public property, upholding India's sovereignty and preserving its composite culture as duties; prohibiting trade in rare and endangered species is not one of them.

Q.23 · Answer (D) Lockjaw
Tetanus is called lockjaw because the toxin's muscle spasms clamp the jaw shut.

Q.24 · Answer (C) Kushana
The fourth Buddhist council, held in Kashmir under the Kushana king Kanishka, saw Buddhism split into the Hinayana and Mahayana schools.

Q.25 · Answer (D) Kerala
Kerala has the highest road density of these states: the most road length per square kilometre of area.

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.1 · Answer (D) 20%
He now charges ₹7.2 for 900 g, which is 7.2 ÷ 0.9 = ₹8 per kg. From ₹10 to ₹8 is a fall of 20%.

Q.2 · Answer (A) ₹90
The mixture costs 20 × 30 = ₹600, of which the cheaper wheat is 15 × 10 = ₹150. So 5 kg of the costlier wheat cost ₹450: ₹90 per kg.

Q.5 · Answer (C) 26.67 cm
The centre O is $\sqrt{(20^2 - 16^2)} = 12$ cm from the chord's midpoint M. Triangles OMA and OAT are similar (right-angled at M and A, with the angle at O common), so TA = OA × AM/OM = 20 × 16/12 = 26.67 cm.

Q.6 · Answer (A) 82°
Q = P − 20° and R = Q − 26° = P − 46°. P + Q + R = 3P − 66° = 180°, so P = 82°.

Q.7 · Answer (D) 47
If Ravi had r, Kavita had r + 12, and 3(r + 13) = 4(r + 1). So 3r + 39 = 4r + 4, r = 35 and Kavita had 47.

Q.10 · Answer (B) 24
Triangles XQO and ZPO have right angles at Q and P, equal vertically opposite angles at O and XQ = ZP, so they are congruent (AAS) and OZ = OX = 12 cm. ZX = 24 cm.

Q.11 · Answer (B) ₹90,000
Price = k × weight². Taking the weight as 10 units, the whole diamond is worth 100k and the pieces 16k + 9k + 4k + k = 30k. The loss of 70k is ₹63,000, so k = ₹900 and the diamond was worth ₹90,000.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Increases, 20%
A 300% rise multiplies the price by 4 and a 70% cut the consumption by 0.3, so spending is multiplied by 4 × 0.3 = 1.2: an increase of 20%.

Q.19 · Answer (D) 3,600
With ₹P in A: P × 8 × 5/100 + 4P × 5 × 7/100 = 0.4P + 1.4P = 1.8P = ₹1,620, so P = ₹900 and B received 4 × 900 = ₹3,600.

Q.21 · Answer (B) 180 km/h and 108 km/h
Together the trains are 400 m long. Same direction: the difference of their speeds is 400/20 = 20 m/s; opposite: the sum is 400/5 = 80 m/s. So the speeds are 50 m/s and 30 m/s, that is 180 km/h and 108 km/h.

English Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (B) DBCA
D introduces house sparrows, B says they are among the commonest birds, C that their constant presence makes us overlook them, and A, with 'However', turns to their decline: DBCA.

Q.2 · Answer (A) She tried to manoeuvre her trolley around people.
'Manoeuvre' is spelt correctly; the others should read 'anomaly', 'entrepreneurs' and 'liturgy'.

Q.3 · Answer (A) To start or create something from the very beginning
To 'start from scratch' is to begin at the very beginning, with nothing done beforehand.

Q.4 · Answer (B) the agitators to back in
To retreat is to 'back off' (or 'move back'): 'told the agitators to back off'. 'Back in' means to go in backwards.

Q.5 · Answer (A) she planned to try something different yesterday / so she rented the latest romantic / and to her surprise she enjoyed it very much / so much so that
'Though Sheela loves watching horror movies, she planned to try something different yesterday, so she rented the latest romantic, and to her surprise she enjoyed it very much, so much so that she rented another romantic today.'

Q.6 · Answer (A) cohesion and erode
'Cohesion and erode' keeps the sense: the linkages break the nation-state's unity and wear away its relations with society. The other pairs do not fit the sentence.

Q.7 · Answer (C) The assigned task had been finished by the cashier on time.
The past perfect 'had finished' becomes 'had been finished' in the passive.

Q.8 · Answer (B) Decorate
To 'garnish' food is to 'decorate' it.

Q.9 · Answer (C) resolute
'Determined' and 'resolute' both mean firmly set on a purpose.

Q.10 · Answer (B) is smaller than yours
His house is compared with your house, so the possessive pronoun is needed: 'smaller than yours'.

Q.11 · Answer (B) stable
'Capricious' means given to sudden changes; its opposite is 'stable': prices have remained stable for weeks.

Q.12 · Answer (A) The researcher is collecting data.
'Is being collected' is the present continuous passive, so the active is 'is collecting'.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Bright
The opposite of 'dark' is 'bright'.

Q.14 · Answer (B) Magician
A magician performs magic tricks to entertain an audience.

Q.15 · Answer (D) Fundamentels
The correct spelling is 'Fundamentals'.

Q.16 · Answer (A) an apparent misfortune that eventually has good results
A 'blessing in disguise' is an apparent misfortune that turns out well.

Q.17 · Answer (C) Festive
'Desolate' means bleak and joyless; its opposite is 'festive'.

Q.18 · Answer (C) the interior of a restaurant
The restaurant has already been mentioned, so it takes the definite article: 'the interior of the restaurant'.

Q.19 · Answer (A) Hostage
A hostage is held captive until demands, such as a ransom, are met.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Error
A 'fallacy' is a mistaken belief or argument: an 'error'.

Q.21 · Answer (B) several
She moved 'several years ago'; 'immense', 'enormous' and 'particular' do not describe a number of years.

Q.22 · Answer (D) relieved
'But' sets her relief against being overwhelmed: she was 'relieved' to find a house next to a school.

Q.23 · Answer (A) unpleasant
'Unfortunately' signals that the surprise was 'unpleasant'.

Q.24 · Answer (B) available
The half-day programme was the only 'available' option: the full-day slots had all been claimed.

Q.25 · Answer (D) required
Parents assume free, full-day kindergarten is a 'required', that is standard, part of public education.

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